UNDP Human Development Report of 1995. This uses estimated earned income based on non-agricultural wages, percentage of Parliamentary seats by gender, percentage of technical positions held by women and percentage of legislators, senior officials and managers who are women as indicators. The three dimensions considered in GEM are [1] political participation and decision making, [2] economic participation and decision-making and power over economic resources. The index runs from 0 to 1 with 1 being the maximum, a higher score is always desirable.

If we consider the case of India and its ranking or values in each of the categories we can assess the gender gap in India. According to Human Development Report 2015 India ranks 130 as far as HDI is concerned. The value of Gender Development Index (GDI) is 0.795 and falls under Group 5 of the GDI groups. The Gender Inequality Index (GII) value is 0.563 which shows great disparity between male and female in the indicators and indices shown in Figure 14.2. Percentage of female participation in Parliament is 12.2%.

A striking development took place in the year 2016. 8 March, which is celebrated every year as International Women's Day, saw the adoption of a pledge by the UN on 8 March, 2016, for working towards and achieving 'gender equality'. The 2016 theme for International Women's Day was "Planet 50-50 by 2030: Step It Up for Gender Equality". The 60th session of the UN Commission of the Status of Women, held on 24 March 2016, reaffirmed the commitment of the member states for gender-responsive implementation of Agenda 2030 which among other goals of sustainable development highlighted the most important goal that is to be achieved as 'gender equality.'

As is the usual practice of the UN to declare a theme for International Women's Day every year, the 2017 theme was "Women in the Changing World of Work: Planet 50-50 by 2030". This theme pointed towards dismal representation of women in global labour force. The 2018 theme was "Time is Now: Rural and Urban Activists Transforming Women's Lives". This highlighted gender issues like sexual harassment, femicide, equal pay and women's political representation. The 2019 theme for International Women's Day was #Balance for Better. This aimed at working towards a gender